



RCCG OCEANIA

Family & Parenting

MARRIAGE: DIVINE DESIGN AND PREPARATION

AT A GLANCE

BIG IDEA

Marriage is a sacred union designed by God, reflecting His relationship with the church. To enter this covenant successfully, individuals must prepare through learning, character assessment, and building a strong foundation of companionship. Understanding the divine purpose of marriage helps avoid pitfalls and fosters a fulfilling partnership.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

Genesis 2:18-25

Ephesians 5

Genesis 5:1-2

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Marriage is a divine institution created by God.
- Preparation and selflessness are essential for a successful marriage.
- Character and compatibility are crucial in choosing a spouse.

Marriage reflects the relationship between Christ and the church.

Wrong motivations can lead to marital struggles.

INTRODUCTION

Marriage is more than a social contract; it is a divine institution established by God. It serves as a reflection of His love and unity, mirroring the relationship between Christ and the church. To enter into this sacred covenant, individuals must prepare intentionally, focusing on character, compatibility, and companionship.

SCRIPTURE READING

- **Genesis 2:18-25** — This passage describes the creation of marriage as a foundational institution by God.
- **Ephesians 5** — This chapter compares marriage to the relationship between Christ and the church, highlighting its divine nature.

Genesis 5:1-2 — Illustrates that man and woman together reflect the image of God, emphasizing the unity in marriage.

KEY POINTS

1. **UNDERSTANDING MARRIAGE AS DIVINE** — Marriage is not just a social contract but a divine institution established by God.

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KEY POINTS (CONT.)

1. **UNDERSTANDING MARRIAGE AS DIVINE (CONT.)** — It is meant to reflect His love and unity, as seen in the relationship between Christ and the church. This understanding elevates the purpose of marriage beyond personal satisfaction to a spiritual covenant. Recognizing marriage as a divine design helps couples align their relationship with God's intentions.

- Reflect on how your marriage or future marriage can reflect God's love.
- Discuss with your partner how you can align your relationship with biblical principles.
- Pray together for guidance in fulfilling God's purpose in your marriage.

Scripture: [Genesis 2:18-25](#) [Ephesians 5](#)

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

2. **IMPORTANCE OF PREPARATION** — Entering marriage requires preparation through learning and practice. Understanding the roles and responsibilities within marriage helps avoid common pitfalls. Preparation involves gaining knowledge about what marriage entails and developing the skills necessary for a healthy relationship. This intentional preparation lays a strong foundation for a successful marriage.

- Engage in premarital counseling or marriage preparation courses.
- Read books or attend seminars on biblical marriage principles.
- Discuss expectations and roles with your partner before marriage.

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

3. CHOOSING A SPOUSE WISELY — Character, compatibility, and shared beliefs are crucial when choosing a spouse. Ensuring both partners are in Christ lays a strong foundation. A wise choice in a spouse involves looking beyond superficial attributes to the deeper qualities that contribute to a lasting relationship. Shared faith and values are essential for unity and growth in marriage.
- Evaluate potential partners based on character and shared beliefs.
 - Pray for wisdom and discernment in choosing a spouse.
 - Seek counsel from trusted mentors or spiritual leaders.

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

4. **BUILDING A FOUNDATION OF FRIENDSHIP** — Before marriage, building companionship and understanding each other's dreams and beliefs is essential for a lasting relationship. Friendship forms the basis of a strong marriage, providing support and understanding. Investing time in developing a deep friendship with your partner ensures a solid foundation for the future.
- Spend quality time with your partner to build a strong friendship.
 - Discuss your dreams and beliefs to ensure alignment.
 - Engage in activities that strengthen your bond and understanding.

GROUP DISCUSSION

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

OBSERVATION

- What does Genesis 2:18-25 reveal about the purpose of marriage?
- How does Ephesians 5 describe the relationship between Christ and the church?
- What aspects of God's image are reflected in the unity of marriage according to Genesis 5:1-2?

INTERPRETATION

- Why is it important to view marriage as a divine institution?
- How can understanding the divine purpose of marriage influence our approach to it?
- In what ways does preparation impact the success of a marriage?

APPLICATION

- How can you prepare yourself for a future marriage or strengthen your current one?
- What steps can you take to ensure you choose a spouse wisely?
- How can you build a strong foundation of friendship in your relationship?

PRAYER FOCUS

- Pray for wisdom and discernment in choosing a life partner.
- Ask for guidance in aligning your marriage with God's divine purpose.
- Seek strength to build a foundation of friendship and selflessness in your relationship.

NEXT STEP

Engage in intentional preparation for marriage by studying biblical principles and seeking wise counsel.

CONCLUSION

Marriage is a divine institution that requires intentional preparation and selflessness. By understanding its sacred nature and aligning with God's purpose, individuals can build fulfilling and enduring partnerships. Through preparation, wise choices, and a foundation of friendship, marriage can truly reflect the love and unity intended by God.